

Chuyu Tian

(917) 826-1805 | ct2823@columbia.edu

www.chuyutian.com | <https://nonwesternphilosophy.wordpress.com/>

AREAS OF SPECIALIZATION

Ancient Greek Philosophy, Classical Buddhist Philosophy

AREAS OF COMPETENCE

Classical Chinese Philosophy, Ethics, Political Philosophy

EMPLOYMENT

Pomona College

Visiting Assistant Professor in Philosophy

2026-2027

Purchase College, SUNY

Lecturer in Philosophy

2025–2026

EDUCATION

Columbia University

Ph.D. in Philosophy

2017–2025

The Measure of Goodness: The Virtuous Human and the Citizen Animal

Examining Committee: Wolfgang R. Mann (sponsor), Richard Kraut, Lydia Goehr, Elizabeth Scharffenberger, Taylor Carman

M.Phil. in Philosophy

2019–2021

M.A. in Philosophy

2017–2019

Northwestern University

BA (Cum Laude), Philosophy major (Honors), Economics major, German minor

2012–2016

Honors thesis: Moral Community in the Ethics of Aristotle and Confucius

Goethe-Universität Frankfurt Exchange Student in Philosophy

2015

DISSERTATION ABSTRACT

My dissertation advances a *phronimos*-centered account of Aristotelian ethics. While the *phronimos*, the person of practical wisdom, is often treated as someone with unique epistemic access to ethical truths, I argue that the *phronimos* defines what is good for human beings by being both a *standard-bearer* for whom what is good is good and a legislator. Extending this account to Aristotle's political theory, I argue that full citizenship represents the *telos* of human life, yet is reserved for a narrow, propertied class. The virtues Aristotle promotes reflect the

common interest of this exclusive citizenry and the human good, a particular political order. This helps answer a long-standing debate over the priority between his ethics and politics. My project highlights tensions between political stability, which relies on inclusion and voluntary rule, and virtue in Aristotle's political thought. By tying ethical life to civic life and ethical capacity to civic membership, he risks conflating humanity with membership in political community.

GRANTS, HONORS, AWARDS

Dissertation Fellowship, Columbia GSAS	2022–2025
Arts and Sciences Graduate Council Travel Grant	2020
Dean's Fellowship, Columbia GSAS	2019–2020
Benjamin Wolstein Fellowship, Columbia GSAS	2018–2019
Dean's Fellowship, Columbia GSAS	2017–2018
Stephen Toulmin Prize, Northwestern Philosophy	2016

PUBLICATIONS

Forthcoming

Tian, Chuyu. "Chinese Buddhism and Friendship" in *Friendship in Chinese Philosophy*, edited by Eunice Jianping Hu and Mark Cabural. Bloomsbury, forthcoming. Invited Contribution.

Book Reviews

Tian, Chuyu. "Review of *Ziran: The Philosophy of Spontaneous Self-Causation*, by Brian Bruya." *Journal of Asian Studies* 82, no. 4 (2023): 672–674.

Translation

Gan, Xiaoqing. *Laozi: An Axiomatic Interpretation*. Translated by Longyang Sang, Danke Gu, Junchao Wang, Chuyu Tian, Lachun Chen, Jun Mei, and Min Wan. Beijing: Foreign Language Teaching and Research Press, 2024.

Works in Progress

"The Priority Between Aristotle's Ethics and Politics." Revise and Resubmit at *Polis*.

CONFERENCE TALKS

Invited

"The Measure of All Things: Virtues and Rules in Aristotle"

Ancient Philosophy and Mutual Learning of Civilizations, Frontier and Innovation: International Conference for PhD Candidates, Renmin University of China (August 2023)

Refereed

"Natural Resources and Flourishing in Ancient Greece"

University of South Florida ICHS's conference (Apr 2022)

"What Does the Prime Mover Think?"

Fifteenth Annual Marquette Summer Seminar in Ancient and Medieval Philosophy: “Causes and Causation in Aristotle and the Aristotelian Tradition” (June 2021)

“How is Akrasia Possible? Reason, Character, and Decision in Aristotle”

South Carolina Society for Philosophy (Mar 2022)

UNC Charlotte Ethics And Applied Philosophy Graduate Conference” (Apr 2021)

The 42nd Annual Graduate Philosophy Conference at UIUC (Apr 2021)

“Nelson Goodman’s and Huayan Buddhism’s Multiple Worlds Theories”

APA-Central Division Meeting, ISCWP group session: Chinese Philosophy and Recent and Contemporary American Thought (Feb 2020)

Commentaries

For Sarah Magrin, “Who knows you when you know yourself? Plotinus on the Delphic command ‘Know Thyself,’” *Finding the Way to Truth Conference*, Columbia University (Feb 2019)

For Wolfgang Mann, “Spiritual Exercises? ‘Care for the Soul’ and ‘Contemplation,’” *Finding the Way to Truth Conference*, Columbia University (Feb 2019)

For Christopher Bobonich, “On Thinking about the Good in the *Philebus*,” *Workshop in Ancient and Contemporary Philosophy*, Columbia University (Nov 2017)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Ancient Philosophy	Fall 2026
Problems of Philosophy	Fall 2026
Classical Buddhist Philosophy	Spring 2026
Introduction to Asian Thought	Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

Methods and Problems	Spring 2025
Ethics - Moral Philosophy	Fall 2024
Physics and Philosophy	Spring 2024
Topics in Ethics: Responsibility: Conditions, Scope and Limits	Fall 2023
Philosophy and History	Spring 2021
Introduction to Logic	Fall 2020
Introduction to Logic	Spring 2020
20 th Century European Philosophy	Spring 2019
Introduction to Philosophy	Fall 2019
History of Philosophy I: Pre-Socratics through Augustine	Fall 2018

Public Philosophy

Corrupt the Youth Teaching Program	Fall 2022-Spring 2025
Rethink Teaching Program	Fall 2019-Spring 2022

Guest Lectures

“Nagel and the Bat” at Columbia University	Fall 2025
“Parfit on Personal Identity” at Columbia University	Fall 2023
“From Teleology to Messianism: Kant and Benjamin’s Philosophy of History” at Beijing Normal University	Fall 2021
“What does the Prime Mover Think?” at Louisiana State University.	Fall 2021
“Hempel’s ‘Explanation in Science and in History’” at Columbia University	Spring 2021
“Nāgārjuna’s ‘The Dispeller of Disputes’” at Columbia University	Fall 2018

LANGUAGES

Ancient: Classical Chinese (proficiency), Ancient Greek (scholarly proficiency)

Modern: Chinese (native), English (proficiency), German (reading proficiency), Arabic (beginning)

SERVICES

To the Profession

Non-Western Philosophy Reading Group, Columbia University

Co-organizer, Sept 2018–May 2024

Society for Women in Philosophy-NYC Colloquium

Co-organizer, June 2022–Aug 2022

Columbia Neo-Confucianism Seminar, Columbia University

Rapporteur, Sept 2019–May 2020

Minorities in Philosophy, Columbia University

Co-organizer, Jan 2019–May 2020

APA-Central Division Meeting, ISCP group session: Metaphysical Resonances in Chinese and Western Philosophy

Chair, Feb 2020

APA-Eastern Division Meeting, ISCWP group session: Exemplars and Human Flourishing

Chair, Jan 2019

Finding the Way to Truth Conference, Columbia University

Co-organizer, Sept 2018–Feb 2019

Columbia-NYU Graduate Philosophy Conference, Columbia University

Co-organizer, Sept 2017–Mar 2018

To the University

Office of Religious Life, Columbia University

Multi-Faith Fellow, Sept 2023–May 2024

Arts and Sciences Graduate Council, Columbia University

Philosophy Department representative, ASGC external representative to ISSO, Sept 2020–May 2021

Philosophy Department, Columbia University

Graduate Representative, Sept 2020–May 2021

To the Community

Public Scholarship

Translation of the choral sections of Heracles into Classical Chinese verse (complete draft, to be incorporated into an Ancient Greek Heracles production on Youtube)

“Temple of Heaven: When Time Becomes Space” Video on Youtube

Translation of approximately 100 Chinese poems into English, accompanied by essays on Chinese philosophy through online platform “Wenyuan Yahooi”

REFERENCES

Wolfgang R. Mann

Professor of Philosophy, Columbia University
wrm4@columbia.edu

Richard Kraut

Charles and Emma Morrison Professor in the Humanities, Northwestern University
rkraut1@northwestern.edu

Tao Jiang

Professor of Religion and Philosophy, Director of Rutgers Center for Chinese Studies, Rutgers University
tjiang@rutgers.edu

Michele M. Moody-Adams

Joseph Straus Professor of Political Philosophy and Legal Theory, Columbia University
moody-adams@columbia.edu

Emiliano Diaz

Associate Professor of Philosophy, Chair of the Philosophy Department, SUNY Purchase College
emiliano.diaz@purchase.edu